

Glossary

abstinence

The act of refraining from having sex.

acne

Inflammation of the skin, characterized by outbreaks of whiteheads, blackheads, and other types of pimples.

addiction

An intense, often harmful urge to take a substance or do a particular activity regularly.

adolescence

When a person matures from a child into an adult. This time follows the start of puberty.

ailment

An illness.

anatomy

The structure of the body or of a body part.

anxiety

A feeling of unease that may cause a person distress.

app

A computer software program that is downloaded and installed onto a electronic device. Short for "application."

arousal

The act of being sexually excited in response to something.

asexual

A person with no sexual feelings or desire.

assertiveness

Behavior that is confident and forceful.

autonomy

Having the independence to think or act freely.

avatar

A digital representation of a person in a computer game or on an Internet forum.

bacterium

A single-celled microorganism that lives in organic material—such as a body, soil, or water. Some types of bacterium cause disease. *Plural: bacteria*

biological sex

The physical characteristics with which a person is born.

bisexual

Being sexually attracted to both males and females.

blackmail

The criminal act of demanding money from people by threatening to reveal secret or compromising information about them.

blog

A website that records the opinions, thoughts, and experiences of the writer, much like an online journal, but one that anyone can read.

body image

A person's perception of, and thoughts and feelings about, his or her physical appearance.

brainstorming

A group conference to produce ideas and solve a specific problem.

cartilage

Tough and flexible tissue that connects and supports parts of the body, such as the larynx.

cell

A microscopic living unit that forms the basic structure of the human body. There are many

different types of cell, including muscle, blood, and nerve cells.

circumcision

The surgical removal of the foreskin from a male's penis, or the clitoris from a female's vulva.

cisgender

When a person's gender identity as man or woman matches the sex they were assigned at birth; the opposite of transgender.

citizenship

The state of being a citizen and legally belonging to a particular country.

clickbait

An Internet link that is designed to capture attention. When clicked on, it may direct users to sites containing viruses.

clitoris

A highly sensitive part of a female's genitals that gives sexual pleasure when stimulated.

compromise

The resolution of an argument by mutual agreement, usually with both sides making a concession.

conception

When an egg is fertilized by a sperm.

confidence

A person's self-assurance in his or her ability.

consent

A voluntary agreement or permission to do something or to allow something to happen, such as sexual intercourse.

contraception

A range of methods that can be used to prevent pregnancy. There are two types: barrier and hormone-based. Also called birth control.

cookies

Small text files that are created by a website when a user first visits it, and which are stored on the user's computer so that the website can recognize the user on future visits and track the user's preferences.

cross-cultural

Pertaining to multiple different cultures, including their ideas, values, and customs.

cross-religious

Relating to two or more different religions, including the similarities and differences in their beliefs and values.

cyberbullying

The use of technology to bully people, such as through sending them threatening emails, or posting embarrassing or unfair comments or pictures of them on social media.

defamation

The spreading of false information that hurts another person's reputation.

democracy

A political system in which the people elect representatives who rule on their behalf.

depressant

Something that reduces activity. Often used to refer to drugs such as tranquilizers and sedatives that slow down brain activity.

depression

A disorder that affects a person's